



CHECKLIST

E-Commerce Website Checklist

A practical launch review for the store, the customer journey, search visibility, measurement, and the operational details behind a successful order.

Before you open the store to customers, this checklist helps you walk through the places where an online purchase can go wrong.

Designed to be used as a working document, not a sales pitch.

What are you checking before you open the doors?

An e-commerce launch is more than making sure the checkout button works. A customer has to find the product, understand it, trust the store, complete the purchase, receive what they paid for, and have a clear path back if something goes wrong. This checklist follows that whole journey.

1. Store and product fundamentals

Before testing individual pages, make sure the store itself makes sense. A polished interface cannot compensate for incomplete products, unclear policies, or an offer that is difficult to understand.

- ☐ Product catalog is complete enough for launch: names, descriptions, prices, variants, stock status, images, and identifiers are accurate.
- ☐ Every product has a clear reason to exist in the catalog; retired or placeholder products are not discoverable by customers.
- ☐ Pricing, discounts, subscriptions, bundles, taxes, and shipping rules reflect the real commercial model.
- ☐ Inventory behavior is defined. Customers do not reach payment only to discover that an item is unavailable.
- ☐ Product variants behave predictably and preserve the correct image, price, availability, SKU, and URL where the platform supports distinct variant URLs.
- ☐ Returns, refunds, shipping, privacy, and terms information can be found without hunting for it.
- ☐ Contact information and customer support expectations are clear enough that a buyer knows what happens after purchase.

2. Navigation and product discovery

The question here is simple: can someone who does not know your catalog find the right product without already knowing what to search for?

- ☐ Primary navigation reflects the way customers think about the catalog, not the way the internal team is organized.
- ☐ Category pages have a useful purpose and do not simply duplicate each other.
- ☐ Search works with common product terms, alternate names, spelling variations, and useful filters.
- ☐ Filters do not create large numbers of broken, empty, or duplicate URLs that should not be indexed.
- ☐ Breadcrumbs, category links, related products, and other internal paths help customers move naturally through the catalog.
- ☐ Important products are reachable through normal crawlable links and are not hidden behind interactions that search engines or customers may not execute reliably.

3. Product page readiness

A product page has a very specific job: answer the questions a cautious buyer will ask before spending money.

- ☐ The product name tells the customer what the item actually is rather than relying on an internal product code.

- [] The primary image shows the product clearly, with additional images answering practical questions about size, detail, use, packaging, or context.
- [] The description explains benefits and important specifications in plain language. Claims are accurate and supportable.
- [] Price, availability, variants, quantity controls, shipping expectations, and the main purchase action are easy to see.
- [] Product reviews, ratings, guarantees, certifications, or other trust signals are presented accurately and not manufactured or selectively misleading.
- [] The page makes important differences between variants clear. A customer should not have to guess what changes when a size, color, or configuration is selected.
- [] The page has one clear primary action. Secondary actions should not visually compete with the purchase path.

4. Checkout and purchase path

Test the checkout as if you were a customer who has never seen the store before. Do the same tests on a phone.

- [] Cart contents persist as expected when the customer navigates away and returns.
- [] Shipping and tax estimates are understandable and do not suddenly appear as unexplained charges at the last step.
- [] Guest checkout works when the business model does not require account creation.
- [] Required fields are obvious; unnecessary fields are not creating friction.
- [] Validation messages identify what is wrong and how to fix it.
- [] Payment methods actually work in the production environment and handle failures gracefully.
- [] Order confirmation appears after a successful transaction and gives the customer the information they need next.
- [] Order numbers, emails, receipts, fulfillment handoffs, and cancellation/refund paths work end to end.
- [] Test transactions are distinguishable from real transactions and are removed or refunded according to the platform procedure before launch.

5. Mobile, accessibility, and performance

E-commerce problems often surface on a phone first, because small interfaces leave less room for confusing hierarchy and slow interactions.

- [] Navigation, filters, image galleries, variant selectors, carts, and checkout work on touch screens without accidental taps or hidden controls.
- [] Keyboard users can reach interactive elements in a logical order and can see where focus is.
- [] Form labels and errors are understandable without relying on color alone.
- [] Images have useful alternative text where the image conveys information; decorative images are treated as decorative.
- [] The page remains usable when text is enlarged and when browser zoom is used.
- [] Important content is not delayed unnecessarily by heavy scripts, third-party widgets, or oversized media.
- [] Core Web Vitals should be evaluated with real-user data where available, not treated as a single synthetic score. Google currently uses LCP, INP, and CLS as the Core Web Vitals metrics.

6. Search visibility and product data

A store can be conversion-ready and still be difficult for search engines to understand. Treat search setup as part of launch, not a cleanup project for later.

- [] Each indexable product and category page has a useful, unique title and description.
- [] Canonical URLs are intentional and consistent with the URLs customers actually see.
- [] Robots.txt is not accidentally blocking important pages or resources. Remember that robots.txt is primarily a crawling control, not a dependable de-indexing method.
- [] XML sitemaps contain the URLs you actually want discovered and are submitted through Search Console where appropriate.
- [] Product structured data is implemented only where the visible page supports it. Google recommends validating structured data and using URL Inspection before relying on it for search features.
- [] Product pages include the data needed for merchant experiences when the store participates in Google Merchant Center, such as accurate price, availability, and other required product information.
- [] Variant URLs and canonicalization are deliberate; the same product is not accidentally represented by dozens of equivalent URLs.
- [] 404s, redirects, moved products, discontinued products, and renamed categories have a defined handling process.

7. Analytics and measurement

You should know what happened when a buyer moves through the store. If you cannot see the journey, it becomes much harder to explain where the store is working and where it is leaking customers.

- [] Measurement is installed once and tested so events are not duplicated.
- [] Key commerce actions such as product views, add-to-cart, checkout steps, and purchases are recorded according to the analytics platform implementation.
- [] Revenue, currency, transaction identifiers, product identifiers, and item values are passed accurately where supported.
- [] Internal testing and staff orders are excluded from production reporting when practical.
- [] Consent and privacy settings behave as intended for the jurisdictions and customer base being served.
- [] The team knows which reports will be used in the first 30 days after launch.

8. Production and post-launch checks

Launch day is a deployment, not the end of testing.

- [] Production environment is using the correct domain, SSL/TLS certificate, DNS records, payment settings, email sender configuration, and third-party credentials.
- [] No staging banners, test text, placeholder images, debug messages, or internal comments are visible.
- [] Search engine directives match the production intention. A staging noindex or password wall has not been carried into production.
- [] A fresh purchase is tested in production after deployment using the approved process.
- [] Search Console, Merchant Center, analytics, error logging, and monitoring are checked after launch.

- [] The first few real orders are reviewed manually for payment, inventory, tax, shipping, confirmation, and fulfillment accuracy.
- [] The team has a rollback or recovery procedure and knows who owns the decision if a critical problem appears.

A final launch conversation

There is no universal definition of a “ready” store. What matters is knowing which parts of the customer journey have been tested, which parts are still assumptions, and which risks would be expensive to discover after opening. A store that is simple but dependable is usually easier to improve than a store that is sophisticated but unpredictable.

Area	What “ready enough to launch” looks like	Evidence to keep
Catalog	Products, prices, variants, inventory and policies are accurate.	Sample product review; export or admin check.
Discovery	Customers can find products through navigation and search.	Search tests; category walkthroughs.
Product pages	A buyer can understand the offer and make a confident choice.	Mobile/desktop page review.
Checkout	Purchase, confirmation and fulfillment handoff work end to end.	Successful test transaction.
Measurement	Key commerce actions and revenue are being captured correctly.	Analytics debug/test evidence.
Search	Important pages are crawlable, indexable and represented accurately.	Search Console; sitemap; structured-data validation.
Operations	The business can handle the order if demand appears tomorrow.	Fulfillment, support and refund procedures.

Current reference points used in this checklist

Google Search Central - Merchant listings structured data:

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/merchant-listing>

Google Search Central - Product variants structured data:

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data/product-variants>

Google Search Central - SEO Starter / Search Essentials: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/essentials>

Google Search Central - Structured data: <https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/structured-data>

web.dev - Core Web Vitals: <https://web.dev/articles/vitals>